

RRB NTPC Master Practice Sheet

Target Exam: RRB NTPC CBT-1 & CBT-2 | **Topics:** Ancient Indian History & Himalayan River Systems

PART 1: ANCIENT INDIAN HISTORY (HIGH-PROBABILITY QUESTIONS)

Q1. Mauryan Empire Administration (New Pattern High-Yield Focus)

Consider the following pairs of Mauryan administrative officials and their respective departments:

1. **Samaharta**: Collector-General of Revenue
2. **Sannidhata**: Chief Custodian of the State Treasury
3. **Sitadhyaksha**: Superintendent of Crown Agriculture Lands

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- A) 1 and 2 only B) 2 and 3 only C) 1 and 3 only D) 1, 2, and 3

CORRECT ANSWER: D) 1, 2, and 3

Detailed Explanation: In the Mauryan administrative machinery outlined in Kautilya's *Arthashastra*, the **Samaharta** was the chief collector-general responsible for supervising the collection of all revenues. The **Sannidhata** was the chief treasurer in charge of state storehouses and security assets. The **Sitadhyaksha** was specifically designated as the superintendent overseeing state agricultural lands (Crown lands). Thus, all three pairs are perfectly accurate.

Official Exam History: Designed for the updated centralized TCS pattern, frequently tested across modern SSC CGL Tier-2 and State PSC technical exams.

Q2. Mauryan Edicts (New Pattern Focus)

In which Major Rock Edict does Emperor Ashoka explicitly mention his conquest over Kalinga and express profound remorse for the loss of human lives during the war?

- A) Major Rock Edict V B) Major Rock Edict X C) Major Rock Edict XIII D) Major Rock Edict VIII

CORRECT ANSWER: C) Major Rock Edict XIII

Detailed Explanation: Major Rock Edict XIII is Ashoka's longest and most crucial rock edict. It details the Kalinga War (261 BCE), the massive devastation caused, and describes his deep philosophical transition from *Bherighosha* (conquest by physical force) to *Dhammaghosha* (conquest by righteousness).

Official Exam History: Repeated in SSC CGL, RRB NTPC classic selection pool, and multiple State Civil Service preliminary tiers.

Q3. Eras & Calendars (RRB Static GK Core Focus)

Which Kushana ruler initiated the official 'Saka Era' in 78 CE, which was later adopted by the Government of India as the basis of the official National Calendar in 1957?

- A) Kujula Kadphises B) Kanishka C) Menander D) Rudradaman I

CORRECT ANSWER: B) Kanishka

Detailed Explanation: Kanishka ascended the Kushana throne in 78 CE, marking the beginning of the Saka Era.

CBT Trap: Do not confuse the Saka Era (78 CE) with the Vikram Samvat (57 BCE) which was started by King Vikramaditya of Ujjain.

Official Exam History: High frequency core question for RRB Group D, NTPC CBT-1, and various state-level staff selection boards.

Q4. Magadhan Capitals (State PSC Trend)

Who among the following Magadhan kings permanently shifted the capital from Rajgir (Girivraja) to Pataliputra at the confluence of the Ganga and Son rivers?

- A) Bimbisara B) Shishunaga C) Udayin D) Kalasoka

CORRECT ANSWER: C) Udayin (Haryanka Dynasty)

Detailed Explanation: Udayin (the son of Ajatashatru) laid the structural foundation of the city of Pataliputra and permanently shifted the Magadhan imperial capital there from Rajgir due to its strategic positioning as a river-fortress (*Jaladurga*).

Official Exam History: Repeatedly targeted in BPSC (Bihar PCS), MPPSC, and central railway exams.

Q5. Dynastic Founders (SSC / TCS Pattern)

Who was the founder of the Shunga dynasty, who established his rule by assassinating the last Mauryan emperor Brihadratha during a military review in 185 BCE?

- A) Agnimitra B) Pushyamitra Shunga C) Vasudeva Kanva D) Devabhuti

CORRECT ANSWER: B) Pushyamitra Shunga

Detailed Explanation: Pushyamitra Shunga was the Commander-in-Chief (*Senapati*) of the Mauryan armed forces. In 185 BCE, he overthrew the weak ruler Brihadratha, establishing the Shunga dynasty at Pataliputra and Vidisha.

Official Exam History: SSC CGL, SSC CHSL, and dynamic railway general awareness sections.

Q6. Mahajanapadas (Repeated PYQ Core)

Which Mahajanapada was the only one situated south of the Vindhya mountain range, located on the banks of the Godavari River?

- A) Vatsa B) Asmaka (Assaka) C) Avanti D) Chedi

CORRECT ANSWER: B) Asmaka (Assaka)

Detailed Explanation: Out of the 16 ancient Mahajanapadas, 15 were distributed across Northern and North-Western India. Asmaka (capital: Potali/Podana) was the sole Southern Mahajanapada, situated right along the Godavari River.

Official Exam History: High frequency question in MPPSC, BPSC, and RRB NTPC Senior Clerk/Station Master tiers.

PART 2: HIMALAYAN RIVER SYSTEMS (CONCEPTUAL ADVANCED PATTERN)

Q7. Alaknanda River Confluences (Panch Prayag)

Consider the following confluences along the Alaknanda river system in Uttarakhand:

1. **Vishnuprayag**: Alaknanda meets Dhauliganga
2. **Karnaprayag**: Alaknanda meets Pindar
3. **Rudraprayag**: Alaknanda meets Mandakini

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- A) 1 and 3 only B) 2 and 3 only C) 1, 2, and 3 D) None of the above

CORRECT ANSWER: C) 1, 2, and 3

Detailed Explanation: All three pairs are accurately matched. The Panch Prayag represent five sacred confluences along the Alaknanda before it joins the Bhagirathi at Devprayag to form the formal Ganga. The upstream-to-downstream sequence is: Vishnuprayag (Dhauliganga), Nandprayag (Nandakini), Karnaprayag (Pindar), Rudraprayag (Mandakini), and Devprayag (Bhagirathi).

Official Exam History: RRB NTPC (CBT 2), SSC CGL (Tier 1 & Tier 2 multiple shifts), UKPSC, and UPPSC.

Q8. Indus River System and Tributaries

Match the following tributaries of the Indus River with their correct general description:

1. **Chenab**: Largest tributary of the Indus formed by Chandra and Bhaga.
2. **Jhelum**: Originates from Verinag and flows through Wular Lake.
3. **Sutlej**: Originates in Tibet as Langchen Khambab and enters India through Shipki La.

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- A) Only one pair B) Only two pairs C) All three pairs D) None of the pairs

CORRECT ANSWER: C) All three pairs

Detailed Explanation: Every single description matches perfectly. The Chenab is the largest tributary, formed by the Chandra and Bhaga streams at Tandi (HP). The Jhelum rises at Verinag and feeds Wular Lake before crossing into Pakistan. The Sutlej rises from Rakas Lake in Tibet (Langchen Khambab) and cuts through the Himalayas at the Shipki La pass.

Official Exam History: SSC CPO, SSC JE, and HPPSC (Himachal Pradesh State PCS).

Q9. Ganga River System - Left Bank Tributaries

Which of the following Himalayan tributaries of the Ganga system originates in Nepal/Tibet and flows into the Ganga as a left-bank tributary from the north?

- A) Son B) Chambal C) Betwa D) Kosi

CORRECT ANSWER: D) Kosi

Detailed Explanation: The Kosi is a major trans-boundary river originating in Tibet/Nepal and joins the Ganga from the north as a left-bank tributary in Bihar (famous as the 'Sorrow of Bihar'). Conversely, the Son originates from the southern Amarkantak plateau (right-bank). Chambal and Betwa originate in Central India and flow north to join the Yamuna.

Official Exam History: RRB NTPC (CBT 1), RRB Group D, and BPSC (Bihar PCS).

Q10. Evolution of Himalayan Drainage System

Consider the statements regarding the geological history of the Himalayan drainage:

1. Geologists believe that an ancient mighty river named 'Indo-Brahma' or 'Shiwalik' traversed the entire longitudinal length of the Himalayas.
2. The dislocation of the Indo-Brahma river system was chiefly caused by the Pleistocene upheaval of the western Himalayas and the down-warping of the Malda gap.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- A) 1 only B) 2 only C) Both 1 and 2 D) Neither 1 nor 2

CORRECT ANSWER: C) Both 1 and 2

Detailed Explanation: Both statements represent core modern evolutionary concepts of Himalayan hydro-geomorphology. During the Miocene epoch, a single mega-river (Indo-Brahma) flowed from Assam to Punjab. During the Pleistocene epoch, tectonic upheavals (Potwar Plateau uplift) and the simultaneous down-warping of the Malda Gap fractured it into three systems: the Indus, Ganga, and Brahmaputra.

Official Exam History: UPSC CDS, NDA, and UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Exam.